Ray Mark

Marketing Director · Brand, Media & Creative · Entertainment, Hospitality & Travel
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Marketing leader across client, agency, and founder roles, fluent in media and creative. Ran marketing for Cirque du Soleil ‘Auana and paid media for Samsung’s Cannes Lions–winning work.

EXPERIENCE

Cirque du Soleil **Aug 2024 – Oct 2026**

Director of Marketing *Honolulu, HI*

- Led marketing for ‘Auana, Cirque du Soleil’s first resident show in Hawai‘i: 470K+ guests and $47M+ in ticket revenue across 868 performances in under two years.
- Owned a $2M+ annual sales, marketing, and communications budget against KPI and EBITDA targets, allocating spend across paid, partner, and on-property channels.
- Oversaw a team of 3 managers and 1 coordinator, plus U.S. media and sales agency partners.
- Drove $1.9M in pre-sales, topped the launch budget by 16%, and hit $25M in year one, ahead of budget.
- Built ‘Auana’s brand guidelines and key visuals, directed shoots, and produced all creative in-house.
- Directed a ~$1M digital program across Google, Meta, The Trade Desk (programmatic and CTV), Spotify, TikTok, and Snapchat: 16x ROAS on paid social at a $19 CPA, and 24x on Google Ads.
- Created the kama‘āina (local) strategy: 119K+ tickets ($10.4M), Aloha Fridays ($530K+), and Pau Hana Partners, a no-cost dining and parking perk with five Waikīkī restaurants.
- Grew visitor ticket sales 15% (+$960K) on 4% fewer shows by expanding in-market media; outdoor ad recall rose from 9% to 27%, the highest of any medium.
- Managed Japan and Korea agencies; Japan became the top international market ($4.5M+, +15% YoY).
- Launched seasonal offers, including a $3M+ family program and a 24-hour July 4 BOGO that lifted a soft show from 33% to 67% occupancy, plus a $411K Black Friday/Cyber Monday.
- Marketed the official soundtrack, announced at the Aloha Tokyo Festival: 240K+ streams in 10 weeks and a 27% Apple Music save rate, 5x benchmark.

WYD Agency **Jun 2016 – Aug 2024**

Co-founder & Creative Director *Honolulu, HI*

- Co-founded a boutique agency serving 30+ clients, including Dolby, RCA, Rakuten, and start-ups.
- Scaled Cannable, a California cannabis delivery start-up, from $2.9K to $176K in weekly sales in 13 months ($8.4M gross, 78K+ orders, 52% repeat customers).
- Designed 70+ websites, brand identities, packaging systems, and campaigns hands-on, bringing in freelance specialists as needed.

Lights On Digital **May 2023 – Dec 2023**

Senior Director of Marketing Strategy *Honolulu, HI*

- Headed client services, creative, and performance marketing for 5 luxury hotels; built the team’s career ladder and managed 4 account staff.
- Produced a record-setting Black Friday/Cyber Monday campaign for The Kahala Hotel & Resort ($1.2M+) across paid media, email, and social.
- Boosted direct bookings 20%+ via email automation (OTA winback, cancellation, abandonment).

Carat **Aug 2015 – Jun 2016**

Associate Media Director *New York, NY*

- Headed media planning and buying for MasterCard's U.S. consumer segment across digital and traditional channels, including the Internationalist Award–winning #STANDUP4.
- Delivered quarterly business reviews that secured a 15% paid media budget increase.
- Planned paid media for MasterCard's Priceless Cities, MasterPass, music, and cross-border travel campaigns, from annual strategy through tactical activation.

Starcom MediaVest Group **Jun 2012 – Aug 2015**

Associate Media Director *New York, NY*

Promoted from Media Supervisor (Jun 2012 – Oct 2013)

- Led the integrated paid media team for Samsung Mobile USA on Cannes Lions and Effie-winning consumer and B2B campaigns.
- Directed U.S. media strategy and buying ($250M+ per quarter), national and local, across general-market and Hispanic campaigns.
- Drove paid media for the first-ever Oscars product integration, the Oscars Selfie: 3.4M+ retweets, $730M+ in earned media in 10 days, and +18% likelihood to recommend.
- Pioneered airport Wallhugger charging stations as a new OOH medium (416 placements, four airports): +4 pts awareness, −3 pts competitor preference.
- Planned the JAY Z *Magna Carta Holy Grail* sponsorship: 1M+ app downloads in 72 hours, +2.1% market share, and +3 pts brand preference.
- Grew Samsung Mobile's Facebook following from 6M to 23M in six months.

EDUCATION

University of South Florida

B.A., Mass Communications (Advertising) *Tampa, FL*

- Magna Cum Laude, with Honors; Zimmerman Advertising Program graduate

CORE COMPETENCIES

Brand Strategy • Integrated Marketing • Launch & Go-to-Market • Partnerships & Sponsorships
Media Planning & Buying • Performance Marketing • Programmatic & CTV • Marketing Analytics
Creative Direction • Art Direction • Public Relations • CRM & Lifecycle • Agency Management
Team Leadership • Budget & P&L Ownership • Pricing & Promotions • Hawai'i Market Expertise

AWARDS

- Cannes Lions – Gold: Branded Content & Entertainment; Silver: Oscars Selfie (Samsung), 2014
- Travel Weekly Magellan – Gold: Hospitality Marketing ('Auana with Outrigger), 2025
- Effie Awards – Gold: Electronics; Silver: Media Idea, Electronics (Samsung), 2013–2015
- Internationalist Awards – Gold: Oscars Selfie, #STANDUP4 (Samsung, MasterCard), 2014 & 2016
- Festival of Media – Gold: Best Use of Programmatic Technology (Samsung), 2015

PRESS

- Pacific Edge Magazine – Hospitality Spotlight interview on building 'Auana, 2026
- HI Now (KHNL) – TV segment from the Aloha Tokyo Festival, Shibuya, June 2026
- Travel Watch (Impress), Japan – Aloha Tokyo Festival coverage, June 2026